First Generation Institute
Microgrant Application

The First Generation Institute microgrants are an opportunity for members of the Twin Cities campus community to be awarded funding to support and advocate for the success and persistence of first-generation students. In our inaugural year, the Institute aims to provide funding and resources to encourage individuals or groups (i.e. departments, collegiate units, student groups, etc.) to work collaboratively on projects to enhance the campus climate for first-generation students. Microgrant awards will be between $500-1500.

This grant cycle will fund projects occurring in the 2019-2020 academic year. Grants will be awarded to support ongoing activities only if the proposal clearly demonstrates how funding is critical to ensure the continuation of the outlined activities or to significantly expand their scope and impact.

FUNDING PRIORITIES

Grants will be awarded to new projects that focus on one or more of these priorities:

1. Expanding visibility and understanding: Projects that are designed to expand our collective understanding of issues that impact first-generation students. These projects ideally focus on the intersectional identities and experiences of first-generation students. They may be trainings, workshops, dialogue circles, special speakers or educational campaigns.
2. Increasing equity and persistence of first-generation students: Exploring ways that shifts or expansions in practice or policy could be made in how we address increasing equity and persistence for first-generation students. They may be projects, events, or departmental or community enclaves initiatives.
3. Improving institutional and community knowledge on first-generation students: These projects explore ways to better understand the first-generation experience and community through data and analysis. This could be gathering of data that leads to developing a project, or evaluating the impact of existing practices. Ideally, these projects will enhance data-informed initiatives to inform campus policy and practice.

Successful applications are those that clearly can articulate how their project/event/initiative will help to support and advocate for the equity and persistence of first-generation students relative to at least one of the above funding priorities.

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This material is available in alternative formats upon request. Direct requests to Kirsten Mortensen, 612-626-7257, mort0076@umn.edu.

APPLICATION DETAILS

Applicants will be asked to cover the following areas in a 750-word proposal narrative.
For complete details, download application form at cehd.umn.edu/firstgen.

1. Grantees

Briefly describe the individuals and/or groups that will be involved in the project or program and their relevant qualifications. Include who, specifically, will be carrying out the planned activities/practices, and how you plan to measure the project progress to goals.

2. Project Description

Describe your request (incorporating the following points):

- ❏ Project or program description: Describe the project you would like to undertake, the needs/issues it addresses and include the tactics that will be employed to meet the strategic goal(s). As much as possible, describe how the work will be operationalized and disseminated on campus.
- ❏ Goals: What are the goals, objectives and activities/strategies involved in this request?
- ❏ Impact: Who are the intended beneficiaries and how will they benefit from the project or program? How are/will they be involved in developing and implementing the program or project? How does it advance the status and/or visibility of first-generation students on campus?

3. Evaluation

Describe how you will know if you have achieved your goal, and how progress of the goal will be measured, identifying specific benchmarks and/or metrics and the timetable for achieving these benchmarks. Who will be involved in the evaluation? What questions will be addressed? How will the evaluation results be used?

DEADLINE AND SUBMISSION PROCEDURES

Please submit your application by 4 p.m. on **Monday, March 4** to Kelly Collins at coll0767@umn.edu.
Decisions will be made by the end of March.

What is the First Generation Institute Conference?

The University of Minnesota Twin Cities is home to a significant first-generation student community, with 26.3% of undergraduates reporting that neither parent received a 4-year college degree. Systemwide, more than 1 in 4 (29%) enrolled undergraduate students are the first person in their family to seek a Bachelor's degree across five U of M campuses.

This conference seeks to empower participants to recognize and affirm the intersectional identities of first-generation college students, examine the complex challenges and opportunities inherent to their experience, and explore practices that invite faculty and staff to take collective ownership of students who are first in their family to go to college. A critical question we seek to explore is not whether our students are ready for college but how our institutions are preparing to be student-ready for our increasingly diverse and intersectional student population. The inaugural First Generation Institute Conference took place November 2018 and planning for future conferences is currently underway.